



The Badshahi Mosque, Lahore, was commissioned by Aurangzeb.

ONE OF THE REASONS GIVEN FOR THE **DISINTEGRATION** of the Mughal Empire after the death of **Aurangzeb** in 1707 has been his supposed religious **persecution of Hindus** and other minorities. Where his predecessor Akbar I had pursued an active policy of religious toleration as the most effective means of controlling his Hindu vassals, Aurangzeb—himself a Sunni Muslim—was said to have **systematically destroyed Hindu temples**. In addition, he banned the use of music, central to Hindu practice, issuing a decree, perhaps in 1669, to this effect. He also had drawn up an **exhaustive digest of Muslim law**, the *Fatawa-e-Alamgiri*, said to have been rigorously imposed. All these claims are disputed, however. In fact, the number of Hindu temples said to have been destroyed varies improbably from 80 to 60,000. That Aurangzeb was **strongly anti-Christian**, though, seems certain to have been true.

£100 MILLION THE ANNUAL REVENUE RAISED BY AURANGZEB'S EXCHEQUER

“COME QUICKLY, I AM DRINKING THE STARS.”

Attributed to Dom Pérignon, while tasting champagne, 1670



IN MAY 1670, THE HUDSON'S BAY COMPANY WAS FORMED under British royal charter on the initiative of two French fur trackers, Pierre-Esprit Radisson and Médard de Groseilliers. They had learned that the **best furs** came from the **Cree territory** to the north of Lake Superior. Easier to reach via Hudson Bay rather than via the rivers and lakes to the south, they proposed a base there. Rebuffed in France, they **solicited support in England**. The Hudson's Bay Company would become one of the great commercial enterprises of England, the **basis of its claim to Canada**, and source of regional rivalry with France.

The claim that in 1670 **Dom Pérignon** (1638–1715), a monk at the Benedictine Abbey of Hautvillers, in Champagne in northeast France, **invented the sparkling wine** of that name, is largely discounted today. In fact,

Cossack leader

Stepan Razin, the Cossack leader who rose up against the nobility and the czar's bureaucracy, is seen here on the Volga River, South Russia.

he was devoted to **eliminating the bubbles** such wines produced, as the pressure they built up in the bottles tended to explode them. But as cellar master of the Abbey, he did make a major contribution to the **production of white wines**, by using grapes otherwise used in red wine. It was not until the early 18th century that the **taste for sparkling wines**, in England and France, grew rapidly.

A **Cossack uprising** in South Russia in 1670 was **brutally suppressed** by the czar, and its leader Stepan Razin was executed the following year. An attempt to protect Cossack independence against the **centralized Russian state** had become a revolt by a disaffected peasantry that saw several cities sacked and looted.



Portuguese glazed tiles decorate the São Miguel Fortress in Luanda, a key military strongpoint in the colonization of Angola in the later 17th century.

IN 1671, PORTUGAL ENDED THE **INDEPENDENCE** of the kingdom of Ndongo, in what is today Angola. A Portuguese colony had largely **dominated the Ndongo** since the 16th century, but a rebellion by their king, Philip, in 1671, saw **Portuguese troops capture the capital** and take control of its entire territory.

Just as fears of Spanish dominance in Europe had allied France, England, and the Dutch Republic, so French dominance after 1659 saw **anti-French alliances** throw Spain and the Dutch Republic together. Spain opposed Louis XIV's claim to the Spanish Netherlands by marriage,

while the Dutch preferred a weak Spain as a neighbor to a strong France. The War of Devolution of 1667–68 had seen French gains, and then losses, in the Spanish Netherlands, but in 1672 Louis, allied with England and Sweden, tried again in the **Franco-Dutch War**. The war ended with the Dutch granting New Amsterdam to England, while the French—although their conquest of the Dutch Republic failed—gained the former Burgundian territory of the Franche-Comté and a string of border territories in the Spanish Netherlands. Yet the peace proved a brief pause in Louis' attempts to expand and safeguard France.



FUR TRADE

A valuable natural asset of North America was fur. It drove the French westward into Canada and saw the English establish the Hudson's Bay Company (see 1670). It also led to Anglo-French conflict there. While the French would accompany the American Indians on fur-trapping expeditions, the English, and the Dutch (pictured) before them, usually took delivery of furs from the Indians at their trading posts. All depended on Indian aid, while the Indians became dependent on European weapons and tools.

March 11 Mount Etna, Sicily, erupts, killing 20,000

Aurangzeb issues **codification of Muslim law**, *Fatawa-e-Alamgiri*

September 6 Ottomans take Candia, Crete, from Venice

Coffee drinking introduced to Paris by Ottoman ambassador

May 2 Hudson's Bay Company established

Date claimed for **discovery of champagne** by Dom Pérignon

June 1 Secret Treaty of Dover signed between England and France

Privateer Henry Morgan captures Panama

Mali capital Niani sacked by Bambara of Segou Empire

First French settlers arrive in what is now Senegal

1671 Ndongo defeated by Portugal and cede territory to Portuguese colony in Angola

April 1671 Battle of Saraghat sees Mughal defeated by Ahom kingdom

1671 German mathematician Gottfried Leibniz builds **first calculator**

1672 English Royal African Company established

June 16, 1671 Execution of Cossack leader Stepan Razin (b. 1630)

December 30, 1671 French Royal Academy of Architecture founded

March 12, 1672 Third Anglo-Dutch War begins (to 1674)